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21LEM202T — Unit 4, Session 3, SLO 1

Session Learning Outcomes

- SLO 1: Resolve common questions on classification — the purpose of the four-order classification, how to determine the order of a given unit, and how to tell whether a Self is associated with a unit.
- SLO 2: Resolve common questions on harmony and mutual fulfilment in nature — natural calamities, the J.C. Bose and Masaru Emoto experiments, 'survival of the fittest', definite conduct, the role of education, and food choices.

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Part A — Key Ideas of the Session

- Why four categories? There are countless units in nature; to understand it we classify them into countable categories. The classification into four orders is based on the common innateness, natural characteristics, activities and inheritance in each order.
- How to determine the order of a given unit (e.g. fish, insect): study its activities, innateness and natural characteristics, and place it accordingly.
- How to know whether a Self (I) is associated with a unit: (1) the presence of the activity of Assuming; (2) a developed part of the body that can communicate with the Self — the brain; (3) it can take signals from the human being.
- 'Living / non-living' and consciousness: clarify whether we associate 'life' with recognizing & fulfilment, with assuming, or with knowing. Recognizing & fulfilment (even sophisticated, as in plants) is often called 'living', and can occur in material units too. The presence of self is marked by the activity of assuming; Self is consciousness.
- Natural calamities (earthquake, landslide, storm): these are physio-chemical activities in material units, based on definite recognition & fulfilment, each participating in a larger order. Isolated activities may appear as disharmony, but holistically there is harmony. Changes in the rest of nature are only physio-chemical — there is no unhappiness there; unhappiness arises only when the Self is in disharmony or participates in disharmony.
- J.C. Bose experiment: it showed fulfilment (response) in plants based on recognition to certain stimuli — still within the domain of recognition & fulfilment. We assign words like 'pleasure' or 'pain' to such responses, but there is no Self involved (a similar thing can be observed in our own bodies).
- Dr Emoto / 'water has memory': a property of a unit is the effect of one unit upon another, and this effect can last a long time — sometimes termed 'memory'. The word 'memory' is used in multiple ways (placed in consciousness as well as in material in the literature); we must make out the precise meaning intended.
- 'Survival of the fittest': first clarify the word 'survival' — conscious units or material units? The self anyway continues; material units are active cyclically. The feeling of struggle is only in the Self; in the rest of nature there are only physio-chemical activities with no feeling. The bio-order's nurture–worsen characteristic is often misread as struggle and hence as 'survival of the fittest'.
- Why must the human order work for definite conduct? First two orders: no Self → only recognition & fulfilment → definite. Animal order: Self co-exists with the body but has no potential to know (only assuming), living governed by the body → definite. Human order: has the potential to know and a will to live with continuous happiness, fulfilled by right understanding & right feeling; since this is not ensured, the

human must work for it — and once ensured, can be far more fulfilling for nature.

• Is education solely responsible for conduct? If ‘education’ means formal education, not solely. If ‘education’ means the process of right understanding in the self, then yes — enabling that process leads to definite conduct. Any other factors are those that facilitate this process of right understanding (for all human beings around the individual).

• Global warming & human activity: it can be owing to several factors; but if we are contributing to the problem, we are not participating in the harmony of nature, and that becomes indefinite conduct.

• Food (vegetarian / non-vegetarian / vegan): the feeling of responsibility toward the body (self-regulation, for nurturing the body) is naturally acceptable, definite and continuous; the choice of food is an expression of that feeling (can have variety, depends on taste). Points to weigh: the construction of one’s body (herbivorous / carnivorous / omnivorous), which order to take food from, the natural acceptance to take away the body from any Self, and sustainability.

The key ideas of the session are summarized in the bullet points provided. No additional answer is required beyond the text already given.

Part B — In-Class Activity

Activity B1 — How do we know a Self (I) is associated with a unit?

List the indicators the session gives for the presence of a Self (I) in a unit.

The indicators for the presence of a Self (I) in a unit are: 1) The unit has consciousness (awareness). 2) It has the ability to assume (imagine, think, decide). 3) It has the ability to recognize and fulfil its natural acceptance. 4) Its activity is based on knowing, assuming, and recognizing/fulfilling, not just physio-chemical processes. 5) It exhibits definite or indefinite conduct (choice-based behavior).

1. Activity B2 — Explore as a proposal (group discussion)

These are open questions from the session — explore them on your own right, as proposals, using the framework (Self / assuming / recognizing & fulfilment, definite vs indefinite conduct). There is no single ‘correct’ answer; reason it out.

1. If some animals are herbivorous and some carnivorous (in keeping with harmony), what about humans eating animals? And how do coastal people who survive on fish fit in? ————————

Humans have the capacity to choose their food based on conscious recognition of harmony, unlike animals that follow innate programs. Eating animals may be seen as an expression of indefinite conduct if it stems from taste or habit rather than necessity. Coastal people eating fish could be a survival adaptation, but the question is whether it is done with a feeling of responsibility toward the body and nature, or merely as exploitation. The framework suggests that humans can move toward definite conduct by choosing plant-based food that fulfills the body's needs without causing harm to other conscious units.

2. While breathing we kill many micro-organisms — is our very survival based on exploitation? How can we then be part of harmony? ————————

Breathing is a physio-chemical activity of the body, not a conscious choice to exploit. The killing of micro-organisms is unintentional and unavoidable for the body's functioning. Harmony in nature includes such inevitable interactions at the material level. The feeling of exploitation arises only when there is conscious intent to harm or use others for selfish purposes. We can be part of harmony by ensuring that our conscious choices (e.g., food, lifestyle) are not based on deliberate exploitation, and by recognizing that our participation in larger orders includes both material and conscious dimensions.

3. Dinosaurs once lived and died — is that in keeping with harmony in nature? In which category do viruses lie?
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The extinction of dinosaurs is part of the natural cycle of physio-chemical and material units in nature; it does not violate harmony because harmony includes change, decay, and transformation at the material level. Viruses lie in the material order (order I), as they are physio-chemical units that replicate but lack consciousness (Self). They do not have the ability to assume or recognize, so they are not in the plant, animal, or human orders.

Part C — Long-Answer Questions

Q1. Answer in your own words, in the space provided.

Q1. Why are the units of nature divided into four categories, and how do you determine which order a given unit (e.g. a fish or an insect) belongs to? (5 marks)

Units of nature are divided into four categories (material, plant, animal, human) based on the presence and level of consciousness (Self) and the type of activity they exhibit. Material units (order I) have only physio-chemical activity. Plant units (order II) have physio-chemical activity plus the ability to respond to stimuli (prana/ life force) but no consciousness. Animal units (order III) have physio-chemical activity, prana, and consciousness (Self) but with assuming based on sensation (instinct), not recognizing natural acceptance. Human units (order IV) have all the above plus the ability to assume, recognize, and fulfil natural acceptance, leading to definite conduct. To determine which order a unit belongs to, observe its activity: if it only grows and decays, it is material; if it responds to stimuli but shows no choice, it is plant; if it shows conscious behavior (e.g., fear, attraction) but is driven by instinct, it is animal; if it can question, choose, and reflect on its own conduct, it is human. A fish is an animal (order III) because it has consciousness and instinctive behavior. An insect is also animal (order III) as it shows conscious responses but no ability to recognize natural acceptance.

Q2. “When there is a natural calamity like an earthquake, it creates so much destruction — how can we say there is harmony in nature?” Respond using the idea of physio-chemical activity, participation in a larger order, and where unhappiness actually arises. (5 marks)

An earthquake is a physio-chemical activity of material units (order I) in nature, which follows natural laws (e.g., tectonic plate movement). Harmony in nature does not mean absence of change or destruction at the material level; it means that each unit participates in a larger order according to its inherent nature. The destruction and suffering we perceive arise from the interaction between material events and conscious units (humans and animals) that experience pain and loss. Unhappiness actually arises in the human Self (I) when we assume that material events should conform to our desires or when we fail to recognize the larger order. The earthquake itself is not 'unharmonious' — it is a natural process. The feeling of disharmony comes from our own assumptions and lack of understanding of the interconnectedness of all orders.

Q3. “There is struggle for survival and survival of the fittest in nature, so why do we say there is mutual fulfilment?” Clarify the word ‘survival’ (conscious vs material units) and explain where the feeling of struggle lies. (5 marks)

The word 'survival' applies differently to material units and conscious units. Material units (order I) simply exist and transform according to physio-chemical laws; there is no struggle — they just participate in cycles. Conscious units (animals and humans) have a sense of self-preservation, but in animals this is instinctive and part of their natural participation (e.g., a herbivore eating plants is not a 'struggle' but a fulfilment of its role). The feeling of struggle arises only in the human Self (I) when we assume scarcity, competition, or fear based on incorrect understanding. In reality, nature provides for mutual fulfilment: plants give oxygen and food, animals give manure and pollination, etc. The 'survival of the fittest' is a misinterpretation of material-level competition; at the level of consciousness, harmony and mutual fulfilment are the natural order when humans live with right understanding.

Self-Reflection (Take-Home)

• Pick one unit you interacted with today and identify which order it belongs to, giving your reason (its activity, innateness or natural characteristic).

• Reflect on your own food choices in the light of ‘feeling of responsibility toward the body’ versus ‘choice of food as an expression of that feeling’: which order do you take your food from, and is it sustainable?

• Take any one ‘problem’ statement you hold about nature (e.g. about calamities, or survival of the fittest) and verify it on your own right using the framework — does it hold as a proposal?

• I interacted with a **dog** today. It belongs to **order III (animal)** because it has consciousness (awareness, emotions like joy and fear) and its activity is based on instinct (assuming based on sensation) rather than the ability to recognize natural acceptance. It does not question its own conduct.

• My food choices are mostly from **order II (plants)** and **order III (animals)**. The feeling of responsibility toward the body would mean choosing food that nourishes without causing unnecessary harm. Eating plant-based food (order II) is more sustainable and aligns with mutual fulfilment, as it does not involve killing conscious units. Eating animal-based food (order III) often comes from habit or taste rather than genuine responsibility. I realize I need to move toward a more plant-based diet to express true responsibility.

• I used to hold the problem statement: "Natural calamities are proof that nature is not harmonious." Using the framework, I verify: A calamity is a physio-chemical activity of material units (order I) that follows natural laws. Harmony is about each unit participating in a larger order according to its inherent nature. The unhappiness I feel is from my own assumption that nature should be 'safe' for humans. The proposal does not hold — nature is harmonious at the level of its own laws; the disharmony is in my own understanding.